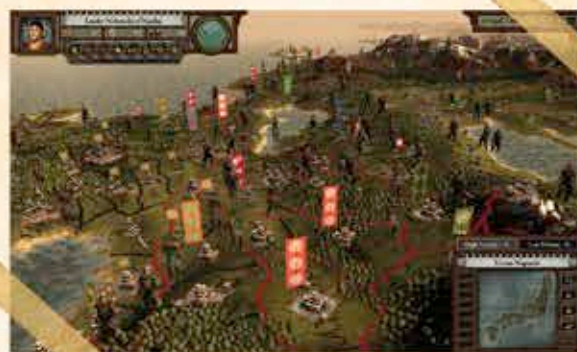
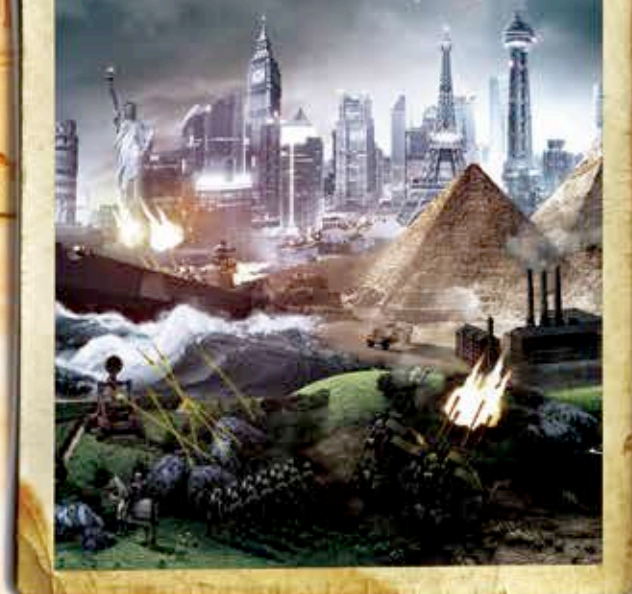




A trip down memory lane: In games like Assassin's Creed, Civilization and Sengoku, these are representations of historical warfare in different eras. History isn't just a passing theme, it's a necessity for these games' inherent appeal.



really learning about a specific period or event in history, we're still learning.

Assassin's Creed

Ahh, Assassin's Creed. Credit where credit is due, this game is gorgeous, and at least architecture wise, they've done a fantastic job. Some of the historical figures they've introduced have actually been represented fairly accurately, others have been tweaked around so that it would fit with the storyline but that's fine with us. Most of us have the common sense to realise that there's no way Leonardo Da Vinci could've been the chief inventor of the Assassin's. But at its very core, the Assassin Brotherhood itself is an inaccuracy. First things first, they weren't even called the Assassin Brotherhood, the more accurate term would be the Nizari Ismailis. In truth, they were a much smaller organisation and composed mostly of people from the Shiite Islamic sect. The Fedayeen or Fidai – which is what Altair was – which translates to “those who sacrifice”, was basically a term for those who were willing to give up their lives in order to

kill their targets. The targets being Sunni muslim leaders in this case. They specialised in disguise and infiltration and so the concept for the game was born. So now you must be wondering where this “Assassin vs Templar” thing comes in if this was a problem between Islamic sects? It may never have actually happened at all for that matter, although it's possible that the assassins quite possibly may have killed a few crusaders here and there. The Nizari Ismailis have a very interesting history in themselves but the fact of the matter is we never would've known about them or been interested about it at all if it weren't for Assassin's Creed.

While we're still on Assassin's Creed let's just mention one more widdle thing. You know how AC3 is literally the story of America? Well sure the characters were tweaked around here and there to suit the plot but there's one thing that was drastically out of place that you probably didn't notice. Remember that scene with Connor Kenway – or Ratonhnhaké:ton; his native name – and the cannons firing

in the background and the American Flag waving about? Pretty epic right? That stars and stripes flag we're all accustomed to? It didn't actually exist at that point of time in history. And don't even get us started on jumping into piles of hay from great heights.

Total War

Now in games like Assassin's Creed historical accuracy isn't really paramount. Sure it helps and the work that's put into it will definitely be a factor, but that isn't the main purpose of the game. It's more like a parallel universe. But when games like the ones from the Total War franchise – which boast historical accuracy – are historically inaccurate? OMG!

Let's use Total War: Rome to illustrate what we mean here. While playing the campaign you come across the Egyptian faction, those of you who know of Rome's rise to power will know of their dealings with Egypt. However, in the game, the Egyptian faction looks very... well, ancient, for lack of a better word. And it's because the depiction actually was off, by a good thousand